BRITISH TERRITORIAL EXPANSION (MYSORE, MARATHAS, SIKHS; SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE & LAPSE)

EXPANSION WAS A LADDER → THE COMPANY FISCAL-MILITARY FLYWHEEL → MYSORE RESISTANCE AND FOUR-WAR → TIPU: REFORM, DIPLOMACY AND → MARATHA CONFEDERACY AND THE → THREE ANGLO-MARATHA WARS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

EXPANSION WAS A LADDER, NOT ONE METHOD

EXPANSION WAS A LADDER, NOT ONE METHOD · FRIENDLY BUFFER PROTECTS COMPANY TERRITORY · SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE · RULER SURVIVES BUT LOSES ARMY, DIPLOMACY AND FISCAL AUTONOMY · COMPANY CLAIMS A SUPERIOR RIGHT TO ARBITRATE INDIAN-STATE CONDUCT · CONQUEST, LAPSE OR ALLEGED MISGOVERNMENT BRINGS DIRECT ADMINISTRATION.

RING-FENCE → friendly buffer protects Company territory

SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE → ruler survives but loses army, diplomacy and fiscal autonomy → PARAMOUNTCY → Company claims a superior right to arbitrate Indian-state conduct → ANNEXATION → conquest, lapse or alleged misgovernment brings direct administration.

CORE CLAIM
- RING-FENCE → friendly buffer protects Company territory
- SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE → ruler survives but loses army, diplomacy and fiscal autonomy

MECHANISM
- PARAMOUNTCY → Company claims a superior right to arbitrate Indian-state conduct
- ANNEXATION → conquest, lapse or alleged misgovernment brings direct administration.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RING-FENCE → friendly buffer protects Company territory
- SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE → ruler survives but loses army, diplomacy and fiscal autonomy

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANNEXATION → conquest, lapse or alleged misgovernment brings direct administration.

01

STAGE 01

THE COMPANY FISCAL-MILITARY FLYWHEEL

THE COMPANY FISCAL-MILITARY FLYWHEEL · BENGAL DIWANI · PREDICTABLE REVENUE AND CREDIT · SALARIED SEPOYS + OFFICERS + ARTILLERY + SUPPLY · ARMY + INDIAN ALLIES · SERIAL VICTORY AGAINST ISOLATED OPPONENTS · CEDED TERRITORY · MORE REVENUE

BENGAL DIWANI → predictable revenue and credit → REVENUE → salaried sepoys + officers + artillery + supply → ARMY + INDIAN ALLIES → serial victory against isolated opponents → VICTORY → indemnity / ceded territory → more revenue → a larger military machine.

CORE CLAIM
- BENGAL DIWANI → predictable revenue and credit
- REVENUE → salaried sepoys + officers + artillery + supply

MECHANISM
- ARMY + INDIAN ALLIES → serial victory against isolated opponents
- VICTORY → indemnity / ceded territory → more revenue → a larger military machine.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BENGAL DIWANI → predictable revenue and credit
- REVENUE → salaried sepoys + officers + artillery + supply

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VICTORY → indemnity / ceded territory → more revenue → a larger military machine.

02

STAGE 02

MYSORE RESISTANCE AND FOUR-WAR SEQUENCE

MYSORE RESISTANCE AND FOUR-WAR SEQUENCE · 1767-69 FIRST · TREATY OF MADRAS; HAIDAR FORCES A NEGOTIATED PEACE · 1780-84 SECOND · HAIDAR DIES 1782; TREATY OF MANGALORE RESTORES CONQUESTS · 1790-92 THIRD · ANTI-TIPU COALITION; TREATY OF SERINGAPATAM CUTS MYSORE · 1799 FOURTH

1767-69 FIRST → Treaty of Madras; Haidar forces a negotiated peace → 1780-84 SECOND → Haidar dies 1782; Treaty of Mangalore restores conquests → 1790-92 THIRD → anti-Tipu coalition; Treaty of Seringapatam cuts Mysore → 1799 FOURTH → Tipu dies; Wodeyars restored under subsidiary dependence.

CORE CLAIM
- 1767-69 FIRST → Treaty of Madras; Haidar forces a negotiated peace
- 1780-84 SECOND → Haidar dies 1782; Treaty of Mangalore restores conquests

MECHANISM
- 1790-92 THIRD → anti-Tipu coalition; Treaty of Seringapatam cuts Mysore
- 1799 FOURTH → Tipu dies; Wodeyars restored under subsidiary dependence.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1767-69 FIRST → Treaty of Madras; Haidar forces a negotiated peace
- 1780-84 SECOND → Haidar dies 1782; Treaty of Mangalore restores conquests

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1799 FOURTH → Tipu dies; Wodeyars restored under subsidiary dependence.

03

STAGE 03

TIPU: REFORM, DIPLOMACY AND BOUNDED INTERPRETATION

REFORM, DIPLOMACY AND BOUNDED INTERPRETATION · STATE CAPACITY · DIRECT REVENUE, ARMY REFORM, STATE COMMERCE AND STRATEGIC PORTS · OTTOMAN, AFGHAN AND FRENCH CONTACTS SOUGHT COUNTERWEIGHTS TO COMPANY · OUTREACH DID NOT CREATE A DEPENDABLE ANTI-BRITISH COALITION · SAFE VERDICT · REAL REFORM AND RESISTANCE, NEITHER CARICATURE NOR MODERN NATION-STATE

STATE CAPACITY → direct revenue, army reform, state commerce and strategic ports

DIPLOMACY → Ottoman, Afghan and French contacts sought counterweights to Company power → LIMIT → outreach did not create a dependable anti-British coalition → SAFE VERDICT → real reform and resistance, neither caricature nor modern nation-state myth.

CORE CLAIM
- STATE CAPACITY → direct revenue, army reform, state commerce and strategic ports
- DIPLOMACY → Ottoman, Afghan and French contacts sought counterweights to Company power

MECHANISM
- LIMIT → outreach did not create a dependable anti-British coalition
- SAFE VERDICT → real reform and resistance, neither caricature nor modern nation-state myth.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- STATE CAPACITY → direct revenue, army reform, state commerce and strategic ports
- DIPLOMACY → Ottoman, Afghan and French contacts sought counterweights to Company power

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFE VERDICT → real reform and resistance, neither caricature nor modern nation-state myth.

04

STAGE 04

MARATHA CONFEDERACY AND THE COHESION PROBLEM

MARATHA CONFEDERACY AND THE COHESION PROBLEM · PESHWA AT PUNE · NOMINAL CONFEDERATE CENTRE · REGIONAL HOUSES WITH SEPARATE INTERESTS · REACH, CAVALRY, REVENUE CLAIMS AND EXPERIENCED COMMANDERS · NO DURABLE COMMON COMMAND; COMPANY BARGAINS AND FIGHTS ONE

PESHWA at Pune → nominal confederate centre

GAEKWAD → regional houses with separate interests → STRENGTH → reach, cavalry, revenue claims and experienced commanders → WEAKNESS → no durable common command; Company bargains and fights one house at a time.

CORE CLAIM
- PESHWA at Pune → nominal confederate centre
- GAEKWAD → regional houses with separate interests

MECHANISM
- STRENGTH → reach, cavalry, revenue claims and experienced commanders
- WEAKNESS → no durable common command; Company bargains and fights one house at a time.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PESHWA at Pune → nominal confederate centre
- GAEKWAD → regional houses with separate interests

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WEAKNESS → no durable common command; Company bargains and fights one house at a time.

05

STAGE 05

THREE ANGLO-MARATHA WARS

THREE ANGLO-MARATHA WARS · 1775-82 FIRST · RAGHUNATH RAO CRISIS · WADGAON REVERSE · TREATY OF SALBAI · 1802 BASSEIN · PESHWA ACCEPTS SUBSIDIARY TERMS AFTER HOLKAR'S VICTORY · 1803-05 SECOND

1775-82 FIRST → Raghunath Rao crisis → Wadgaon reverse → Treaty of Salbai → 1802 BASSEIN → Peshwa accepts subsidiary terms after Holkar's victory → 1803-05 SECOND → Scindia and Bhonsle defeated; Holkar resists and settlement follows → 1817-18 THIRD → Peshwaship abolished; Baji Rao II pensioned at Bithur.

CORE CLAIM
- 1775-82 FIRST → Raghunath Rao crisis → Wadgaon reverse → Treaty of Salbai
- 1802 BASSEIN → Peshwa accepts subsidiary terms after Holkar's victory

MECHANISM
- 1803-05 SECOND → Scindia and Bhonsle defeated; Holkar resists and settlement follows
- 1817-18 THIRD → Peshwaship abolished; Baji Rao II pensioned at Bithur.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1775-82 FIRST → Raghunath Rao crisis → Wadgaon reverse → Treaty of Salbai
- 1802 BASSEIN → Peshwa accepts subsidiary terms after Holkar's victory

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1817-18 THIRD → Peshwaship abolished; Baji Rao II pensioned at Bithur.

06

STAGE 06

SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE DISMANTLED SOVEREIGNTY

SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE DISMANTLED SOVEREIGNTY · BRITISH FORCE STATIONED · RULER PAYS CASH OR CEDES REVENUE TERRITORY · RESIDENT AT COURT · CONTINUOUS POLITICAL LEVERAGE · NO INDEPENDENT WAR · EUROPEAN EMPLOYMENT · EXTERNAL SOVEREIGNTY REMOVED

BRITISH FORCE STATIONED → ruler pays cash or cedes revenue territory

RESIDENT AT COURT → continuous political leverage → NO INDEPENDENT WAR / DIPLOMACY / EUROPEAN EMPLOYMENT → external sovereignty removed → RESULT → protection without capacity; ruler bears blame for a state Britain constrains.

CORE CLAIM
- BRITISH FORCE STATIONED → ruler pays cash or cedes revenue territory
- RESIDENT AT COURT → continuous political leverage

MECHANISM
- NO INDEPENDENT WAR / DIPLOMACY / EUROPEAN EMPLOYMENT → external sovereignty removed
- RESULT → protection without capacity; ruler bears blame for a state Britain constrains.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BRITISH FORCE STATIONED → ruler pays cash or cedes revenue territory
- RESIDENT AT COURT → continuous political leverage

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → protection without capacity; ruler bears blame for a state Britain constrains.

07

STAGE 07

ALLIANCE CASE SEQUENCE AND CONSEQUENCES

ALLIANCE CASE SEQUENCE AND CONSEQUENCES · HYDERABAD 1798/1800 · FRENCH-TRAINED FORCE REMOVED; DEPENDENCE DEEPENS · MYSORE 1799 · RESTORED WODEYAR STATE ENTERS SUBSIDIARY CONTROL · AWADH 1801 · TERRITORIAL CESSION SUBSTITUTES FOR ENLARGED SUBSIDY · BASSEIN 1802

HYDERABAD 1798/1800 → French-trained force removed; dependence deepens → MYSORE 1799 → restored Wodeyar state enters subsidiary control → AWADH 1801 → territorial cession substitutes for enlarged subsidy → BASSEIN 1802 → Peshwa's acceptance transforms a Maratha civil conflict into Company war.

CORE CLAIM
- HYDERABAD 1798/1800 → French-trained force removed; dependence deepens
- MYSORE 1799 → restored Wodeyar state enters subsidiary control

MECHANISM
- AWADH 1801 → territorial cession substitutes for enlarged subsidy
- BASSEIN 1802 → Peshwa's acceptance transforms a Maratha civil conflict into Company war.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- HYDERABAD 1798/1800 → French-trained force removed; dependence deepens
- MYSORE 1799 → restored Wodeyar state enters subsidiary control

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BASSEIN 1802 → Peshwa's acceptance transforms a Maratha civil conflict into Company war.

08

STAGE 08

SINDH AND THE NORTHWEST STRATEGIC CORRIDOR

SINDH AND THE NORTHWEST STRATEGIC CORRIDOR · INDUS COMMERCE + AFGHAN FRONTIER ANXIETY · RISING COMPANY ATTENTION · 1832 COMMERCIAL OPENING · RIVER NAVIGATION WITHOUT MILITARY TRANSPORT · 1839 PRESSURE · SUBSIDIARY OBLIGATIONS LINKED TO THE AFGHAN CAMPAIGN · 1843 MIANI + DABO

INDUS COMMERCE + AFGHAN FRONTIER ANXIETY → rising Company attention

1832 COMMERCIAL OPENING → river navigation without military transport → 1839 PRESSURE → subsidiary obligations linked to the Afghan campaign → 1843 MIANI + DABO → Napier defeats the Amirs; Sindh is annexed.

CORE CLAIM
- INDUS COMMERCE + AFGHAN FRONTIER ANXIETY → rising Company attention
- 1832 COMMERCIAL OPENING → river navigation without military transport

MECHANISM
- 1839 PRESSURE → subsidiary obligations linked to the Afghan campaign
- 1843 MIANI + DABO → Napier defeats the Amirs; Sindh is annexed.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- INDUS COMMERCE + AFGHAN FRONTIER ANXIETY → rising Company attention
- 1832 COMMERCIAL OPENING → river navigation without military transport

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1843 MIANI + DABO → Napier defeats the Amirs; Sindh is annexed.

09

STAGE 09

SIKH STRENGTH, SUCCESSION CRISIS AND TWO WARS

SIKH STRENGTH, SUCCESSION CRISIS AND TWO WARS · RANJIT SINGH · CONSOLIDATED PUNJAB + MODERNISED KHALSA ARMY · AMRITSAR 1809 · SUTLEJ BOUNDARY STABILISES COMPANY-SIKH RELATIONS · COURT FACTION, RAPID SUCCESSION AND ARMY POLITICISATION · 1845-46 FIRST · 1848-49 SECOND

RANJIT SINGH → consolidated Punjab + modernised Khalsa army → AMRITSAR 1809 → Sutlej boundary stabilises Company-Sikh relations → POST-1839 → court faction, rapid succession and army politicisation → 1845-46 FIRST → Lahore/Bhyrowal → 1848-49 SECOND → Gujrat → Punjab annexed.

CORE CLAIM
- RANJIT SINGH → consolidated Punjab + modernised Khalsa army
- AMRITSAR 1809 → Sutlej boundary stabilises Company-Sikh relations

MECHANISM
- POST-1839 → court faction, rapid succession and army politicisation
- 1845-46 FIRST → Lahore/Bhyrowal

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1848-49 SECOND → Gujrat → Punjab annexed.
- RANJIT SINGH → consolidated Punjab + modernised Khalsa army

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1845-46 FIRST → Lahore/Bhyrowal | 1848-49 SECOND → Gujrat → Punjab annexed.

10

STAGE 10

LAPSE, TITLE DENIAL AND MISGOVERNMENT ARE DISTINCT

LAPSE, TITLE DENIAL AND MISGOVERNMENT ARE DISTINCT · ADOPTED HEIR NOT RECOGNISED · SATARA, JHANSI AND NAGPUR ANNEXED · PENSION DENIAL · NANA SAHIB'S PENSION CLAIM IS NOT A TERRITORIAL LAPSE · AWADH ANNEXED IN 1856 DESPITE A RECOGNISED RULING DYNASTY · EXAM RULE · IDENTIFY THE LEGAL PRETEXT BEFORE NAMING THE ANNEXATION POLICY.

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LAPSE → adopted heir not recognised → Satara, Jhansi and Nagpur annexed	MISGOVERNMENT → Awadh annexed in 1856 despite a recognised ruling dynasty	LAPSE → adopted heir not recognised → Satara, Jhansi and Nagpur annexed
TITLE / PENSION DENIAL → Nana Sahib's pension claim is not a territorial lapse case	EXAM RULE → identify the legal pretext before naming the annexation policy.	TITLE / PENSION DENIAL → Nana Sahib's pension claim is not a territorial lapse case

CORE CLAIM
- LAPSE → adopted heir not recognised → Satara, Jhansi and Nagpur annexed
- TITLE / PENSION DENIAL → Nana Sahib's pension claim is not a territorial lapse case

MECHANISM
- MISGOVERNMENT → Awadh annexed in 1856 despite a recognised ruling dynasty
- EXAM RULE → identify the legal pretext before naming the annexation policy.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LAPSE → adopted heir not recognised → Satara, Jhansi and Nagpur annexed
- TITLE / PENSION DENIAL → Nana Sahib's pension claim is not a territorial lapse case

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXAM RULE → identify the legal pretext before naming the annexation policy.

11

STAGE 11

COMPARATIVE ANSWER SPINE AND 1857 BRIDGE

COMPARATIVE ANSWER SPINE AND 1857 BRIDGE · CENTRALISED REFORM BUT DIPLOMATIC ISOLATION · WIDE CONFEDERATE POWER BUT FRACTURED COMMAND · STRONG ARMY AND STATE UNDER RANJIT SINGH; DESTABILISED AFTER · 1857 BRIDGE · DISPOSSESSED RULERS, TALUQDARS AND SOLDIERS ADD GRIEVANCES, NOT ONE

MYSORE → centralised reform but diplomatic isolation → MARATHAS → wide confederate power but fractured command → SIKHS → strong army and state under Ranjit Singh; destabilised after 1839 → 1857 BRIDGE → dispossessed rulers, taluqdars and soldiers add grievances, not one cause.

CORE CLAIM
- MYSORE → centralised reform but diplomatic isolation
- MARATHAS → wide confederate power but fractured command

MECHANISM
- SIKHS → strong army and state under Ranjit Singh; destabilised after 1839
- 1857 BRIDGE → dispossessed rulers, taluqdars and soldiers add grievances, not one cause.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MYSORE → centralised reform but diplomatic isolation
- MARATHAS → wide confederate power but fractured command

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1857 BRIDGE → dispossessed rulers, taluqdars and soldiers add grievances, not one cause.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · EARLY COMPANY POLICY OFTEN SOUGHT BUFFERS, BUT AFTER BENGAL · INCREASINGLY USED WAR, DIPLOMACY, RESIDENTS AND SUBSIDIES TO DOMINATE · WELLESLEY'S SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE TRANSFORMED RULERS INTO DEPENDENT ALLIES · THEY HOSTED BRITISH TROOPS, PAID SUBSIDIES, ACCEPTED A RESIDENT AND SURRENDERED INDEPENDENT · THIS PRODUCED INDIRECT RULE · INDIAN RULERS SURVIVED FORMALLY, BUT SOVEREIGNTY SHIFTED TO THE

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- Early Company policy often sought buffers, but after Bengal the Company
- increasingly used war, diplomacy, Residents and subsidies to dominate Indian states.
- Wellesley's Subsidiary Alliance transformed rulers into dependent allies; they hosted British
- troops, paid subsidies, accepted a Resident and surrendered independent external relations.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- CAUTION: This produced indirect rule : Indian rulers survived formally, but sovereignty shifted to the Company.
- Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse moved from indirect control to annexation by denying adoption rights in selected states.
- Awadh's annexation in 1856 used the separate justification of alleged misgovernance, showing that British expansion used multiple legal pretexts.
- Mysore under Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan resisted through military reform, diplomacy and attempts to balance British power.

LEGACY / NUANCE
- Maratha weakness lay in confederate rivalries; British diplomacy exploited divisions among the Peshwa, Scindia, Holkar, Bhonsle and Gaekwad.
- Sikh power was consolidated under Ranjit Singh, but after his death court
- factionalism and military tensions enabled British victory in the Anglo-Sikh wars.
- CAUTION: Bengal revenues, sepoy armies and superior logistics allowed the Company to fight repeated wars far beyond its original coastal bases.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels